Dear Halden Pay Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role. I bring nine years of experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses at scale, with hands-on experience in Python, SQL, dimensional data modelling, Airflow, dbt, AWS, Snowflake and Redshift. Halden Pay's focus on a shared platform and reusable capabilities aligns closely with the work I have done throughout my career.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own ingestion and orchestration for a platform with approximately 140 Airflow DAGs, and migrated stored procedures into dbt models. Introducing incremental models and CI checks reduced nightly warehouse builds from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I have also established data contracts between product and data teams, built Kafka-based streaming and CDC pipelines, and take part in the platform on-call rotation. This work has strengthened my approach to reliable production systems, data contracts, data quality standards, performance optimization and taking ownership of production issues.

My experience also includes building PySpark jobs on AWS EMR at Kovalent Pay to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files daily. The work reduced month-end manual reconciliation from about three days to four hours. I also designed a dimensional data model and Redshift warehouse schema for finance and risk teams and introduced Great Expectations checks on critical finance tables. At Lukovac Freight Hub, I also optimized Snowflake warehouse sizing, auto-suspend settings and unused-table usage, reducing monthly spend from approximately $38,000 to $24,000 in 2024. Alongside this platform work, I have contributed two merged pull requests to an open-source Airflow provider and presented on data contracts at a regional data meetup.

I would welcome the opportunity to bring this experience to Halden Pay's Data Platform team and help build dependable, reusable platform capabilities for analysts, data scientists and product teams. I would be glad to discuss how my background could contribute.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm